

SERKAN SEFIL

EuropeStudyService – Weekly Project Report

Week 01 – Foundations (UX & HTML)

Objective

The objective of Week 01 was to understand how a digital project begins by moving from a basic client idea to a structured wireframe and website concept.

Tasks Completed

Figma Wireframe Design

Created a mobile-first wireframe in Figma for the project concept. Although the original classroom scenario was "Erasmus Brew," the project idea later evolved into EuropeStudyService, an educational consultancy platform.

The wireframe included:

- Header section
- Hero image placeholder
- About section
- Service/Menu section
- Footer with contact information

Mobile Layout Planning

Used the iPhone mobile frame in Figma to design a layout optimized for smartphone users.

GitHub Repository Setup

- Created GitHub repository
- Organized project folders
- Created week-01 folder structure
- Added design-link.txt file

Course Registration

- Forked the course repository
- Added repository information into student_repositories.md
- Created a pull request for course registration

Results

A structured project foundation was created, including design planning, GitHub setup, and mobile wireframing.

Week 02 – The Skeleton (Semantic HTML5)

Objective

The objective of Week 02 was to transform the wireframe structure into a semantic HTML document.

Tasks Completed

GitHub Codespaces Setup

- Opened repository inside GitHub Codespaces
- Installed Live Preview extension
- Created week-02 folder

HTML Structure Development

Created an index.html file using semantic HTML5 tags.

Implemented:

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- Headings and paragraphs
- Placeholder image structure

Live Preview Testing

Used Live Preview to test and visualize the HTML structure in real time.

GitHub Workflow

- Saved changes
- Used Source Control
- Created commits and synced repository updates

Results

The project gained its first functional webpage structure using semantic HTML.

Week 03 – The Skin (Mobile-First CSS)

Objective

The objective of Week 03 was to style the HTML structure using mobile-first CSS principles.

Tasks Completed

External CSS Setup

- Created styles.css
- Linked CSS file to index.html

Brand Styling

Applied:

- Color palette
- Typography improvements
- Background styling
- Layout spacing

Mobile-First Design

Focused on:

- Responsive layout
- Flexible image sizing
- No horizontal scrolling
- Better touch-friendly spacing

Flexbox & Layout Improvements

Used Flexbox for alignment and layout organization.

Visual Enhancements

Improved:

- Content centering
- Padding and margins
- Menu list styling
- Overall readability

Results

The website became visually structured, responsive, and optimized for mobile devices.

Week 04 – The Management Layer (WordPress & Security)

Objective

The objective of Week 04 was to move from manual coding into professional website management using WordPress.

Tasks Completed

Pantheon WordPress Setup

- Created a free Pantheon hosting environment
- Installed WordPress
- Accessed the development site dashboard

Homepage Development

Built the homepage using Gutenberg blocks:

- Cover block
- Heading block
- Text sections
- Service information

Static Homepage Configuration

Configured WordPress to use a static homepage.

Security Setup

Installed and configured:

- Wordfence Security
- WPS Hide Login

Created a custom login URL for additional website security.

SEO Optimization

Installed RankMath SEO and configured:

- SEO snippets
- Meta descriptions

- Social sharing image

Additional Pages

Created:

- Contact page
- Service/Story pages
- Navigation menu structure

GitHub Documentation

Created site-links.txt containing:

- Public website URL
- Secret login URL

Results

The project successfully transitioned into a live managed WordPress website with security and SEO systems.

Week 05 – Analytics & GDPR Setup

Objective

The objective of Week 05 was to implement website tracking and analytics systems in order to monitor user behavior and understand how visitors interact with the website.

Tasks Completed

- Installed and configured Google Tag Manager (GTM)
- Connected Google Analytics 4 (GA4)
- Added GA4 tracking code through a Custom HTML Tag
- Configured All Pages trigger
- Created a custom event called:

view_services_page

- Implemented GDPR-friendly tracking structure

Tools Used

- Google Tag Manager
- Google Analytics 4

- WordPress

Results

The website can now track page visits and user interactions. This setup allows future analysis of visitor behavior and marketing performance.

Week 06 – AI-Augmented UI Design

Objective

The objective of Week 06 was to improve the visual identity and professionalism of the website using AI tools.

Tasks Completed

Brand Persona Creation

Created a professional brand identity for EuropeStudyService including:

- Modern and trustworthy tone
- Professional blue and gold color palette
- Typography suggestions
- Marketing message for international students

UI Inspiration

Used AI-generated UI concepts to redesign and improve the website layout.

Image Generation

Generated AI-based visual assets for the website to create a more professional appearance.

Manual Improvements

Updated:

- Page spacing
- Typography
- Visual hierarchy
- Hero sections
- Service presentation

Results

The website became visually cleaner, more modern, and more professional for international students.

Week 07 – Lead Generation & Performance Audit

Objective

The goal of Week 07 was to transform the website into a lead-generation platform and improve user engagement.

Tasks Completed

Lead Generation Form

Installed WPForms and created a student contact form including:

- Name
- Email
- University information

GDPR Compliance

Added a GDPR consent checkbox for legal data collection.

Form Automation

Configured:

- Confirmation messages
- Admin email notifications

Performance Audit

Used Lighthouse to analyze:

- Performance
- Accessibility
- SEO

Image Optimization

Learned optimization techniques using compressed image formats and better media handling.

Results

The website can now collect student leads professionally while following GDPR principles.

Week 08 – SEO & Social Visibility

Objective

The objective of Week 08 was to improve the website's visibility on search engines and social media.

Tasks Completed

RankMath SEO Setup

Configured:

- SEO titles
- Meta descriptions
- Focus keywords
- URL slugs

Open Graph & Social Preview

Added:

- Social media image
- Social sharing title
- Social sharing description

Sitemap Configuration

Explored XML sitemap structure using RankMath.

Social Media Presence

Added social media links to improve trust and brand visibility.

Results

The website became more optimized for Google search results and social sharing.

Week 09 – WooCommerce Integration

Objective

The objective of Week 09 was to transform the website into a functional service platform with online ordering capabilities.

Tasks Completed

WooCommerce Installation

Installed and configured WooCommerce.

Product Creation

Created service-based products:

Silver Support Package

Includes:

- Public transportation assistance
- Accommodation guidance
- Health insurance guidance
- Address registration support
- Bank account assistance
- Residence permit guidance

Gold Support Package

Includes:

- Airport pickup
- City orientation
- Accommodation support
- University application support
- Nostrification guidance
- Visa conversion support
- EU driver's license conversion support
- Parent support line

Checkout Configuration

Configured:

- Guest checkout
- Account creation
- Offline payment method ("Pay at Office")

Product Inventory

Configured stock management and product visibility.

Test Orders

Performed successful WooCommerce test orders and verified order creation inside WooCommerce Orders dashboard.

Results

The website now supports service ordering and consultation booking functionality.

Week 10 – Retention, Loyalty & Backup Systems

Objective

The goal of Week 10 was to improve customer retention, loyalty, and website security.

Tasks Completed

Coupon System

Created a promotional coupon:

ERASMUSSTART26

Coupon logic:

- 15% discount
- Encourages first-time student consultations
- Improves conversion rates

Automation Strategy

Planned welcome email automation for new users.

Personalized Form Logic

Added personalization field to forms:

Which country do you want to study in?

Options:

- Czech Republic
- Germany
- Poland
- Other

Data Strategy

Planned personalized communication based on selected destination country.

Backup System

Installed UpdraftPlus and performed a full website backup.

Results

The website now includes:

- Loyalty strategy
 - Customer engagement improvements
 - Personalized communication planning
 - Backup and recovery system
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Final Reflection

Throughout this project, I learned how to:

- Build and manage a professional WordPress website
- Configure WooCommerce services
- Use AI tools for design and branding
- Implement SEO and analytics systems
- Create lead generation workflows
- Improve customer retention strategies
- Use automation and backups for website management

The final result is a professional educational consultancy website prepared for international students who want to study in Europe.

Technologies & Tools Used

- WordPress
- WooCommerce
- Google Analytics 4
- Google Tag Manager
- RankMath SEO
- WPForms
- UpdraftPlus
- AI Design Tools

- AI Image Generators
 - GitHub
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Website Name

EuropeStudyService

Conclusion

This project successfully transformed a simple website into a professional educational consultancy platform with:

- Analytics
- SEO optimization
- WooCommerce integration
- Lead generation systems
- Loyalty tools
- Backup systems
- AI-assisted branding and design

The website is now structured as a modern student support platform for studying abroad in Europe.